

Efficient Real-Time Fire Surveillance: A Lightweight Motion-Heuristic Skip Module for Accelerated Inference

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Abstract

Conventional deep learning (DL)-based fire and smoke detection systems process every frame of a video stream through a computationally intensive model to classify the presence of fire or smoke. However, in surveillance scenarios — particularly indoor environments — video streams frequently contain static, background-only frames devoid of motion or relevant events, rendering per-frame inference redundant and wasteful of computational resources. To address this limitation, this study proposes a novel skip-module mechanism that leverages motion detection to selectively bypass DL inference on non-informative frames in fire and smoke classification pipelines. Evaluation on a large-scale dataset comprising 150 indoor videos demonstrates that the proposed method substantially improves processing throughput while preserving detection performance. Specifically, the skip module enable the system a 30% increase in frames per second (FPS) with a minimal reduction in recall of only 1% relative to the baseline (recall 95%), demonstrating the feasibility of plug-and-play inference acceleration for real-time fire and smoke surveillance systems.

1 Introduction

Fires and wildfires, if not detected and controlled in their early stages, can quickly escalate — especially under dry and windy conditions — resulting in catastrophic consequences including loss of life, destruction of property, and damage to natural ecosystems. For instance, in 2017, urban fires and wildfires in California, USA, caused an estimated economic loss of 10 billion USD [1]. More recently, in 2025, a forest fire in Gyeongsang Province, South Korea, burned approximately 90,000 acres, resulting in at least 27 fatalities and the evacuation of nearly 40,000 residents [2]. Automated early-stage fire and smoke detection systems are therefore critical for enabling timely intervention and minimizing damage.

Numerous fire and smoke detection methods leveraging deep learning (DL) have been proposed in recent years [3], [4]. In practical deployments, these systems are commonly applied to CCTV video streams, where DL-based classifiers or object detectors perform inference on each frame individually. Although this frame-wise paradigm is straightforward to implement, it exhibits two key limitations. First, it relies exclusively on spatial information within individual frames, neglecting temporal cues — such as motion — inherent in video data. Second, in surveillance scenarios, particularly in indoor environments, consecutive frames often exhibit minimal variation due to static scene content. Applying a DL model indiscriminately to every frame under such conditions is computationally redundant, increasing processing cost and latency without contributing to detection performance. This inefficiency is further compounded by the well-known accuracy–efficiency trade-off in DL: more accurate models are generally more computationally intensive, and redundant frame processing amplifies these demands, rendering real-time performance difficult to achieve.

A common strategy to reduce inference cost is to substitute a heavy, high-accuracy DL model with a lighter alternative; however, this typically degrades detection reliability — an unacceptable compromise in safety-critical applications such as fire and smoke detection. This study takes a complementary approach: rather than replacing the classifier, we introduce a lightweight skip-module that acts as a computational gate, selectively forwarding only frames with significant scene activity to the high-capacity classifier while bypassing static, non-informative frames. As illustrated in Fig. 1, the conventional pipeline processes every frame through the classifier, whereas the proposed pipeline inserts the skip-module upstream to conditionally suppress redundant inference calls.

In particular, our main contributions are summarized as follows:

- **Skip-Module Mechanism:** We propose a lightweight skip-module that exploits motion estimation via frame differencing to identify static scenes and bypass DL inference on non-informative frames, reducing computational cost without modifying the underlying classifier. The module is designed as a plug-and-play component compatible with existing fire and smoke detection pipelines. To identify the optimal operating configuration, we further develop a systematic hyperparameter optimization procedure that maximizes throughput while preserving detection performance.
- **Indoor Fire and Smoke Video Dataset:** We construct an annotated dataset comprising 150 indoor fire and smoke videos — including fire, smoke, and background-only classes — captured by static surveillance cameras at resolutions from 720p to 1080p. The dataset covers diverse environments such as warehouses, parking areas, and offices under varying lighting conditions, providing a realistic benchmark for evaluating detection systems in static surveillance scenarios.
- **Comprehensive System Evaluation:** We integrate the skip-module with a high-capacity DL classifier (BIG model) and evaluate the combined system on our video dataset against the baseline (BIG model without skipping) and existing

methods. Results demonstrate a 30% improvement in FPS with a recall reduction of less than 1%, alongside an ablation study that provides insights into system performance and limitations.

The rest of this paper is organized as follows: Section 2 reviews existing fire and smoke detection methods for video and relevant motion detection techniques, contextualizing the need for efficient processing in static surveillance scenarios. Section 3 describes the proposed system architecture, the design of the skip-module, its integration with the BIG model, and the hyperparameter optimization strategy. Section 4 presents the experimental setup, evaluation metrics, and performance results on our large-scale indoor video dataset. Finally, Section 5 summarizes the key findings and discusses limitations and future research directions.

2 Related Work

Fire and Smoke Detection in Images and Videos: Automated fire and smoke detection has attracted considerable research interest, with deep learning emerging as the dominant paradigm. [3] provide a comprehensive survey of visual fire detection methods, highlighting the rapid adoption of DL-based approaches in this domain. The majority of these methods formulate the problem as image-level binary classification (fire/smoke vs. none) or object detection, in which a model receives a single RGB image and outputs either a class label with confidence score or localized bounding boxes [5], [6]. Research efforts have primarily focused on improving model accuracy and inference speed through architectural modifications and advanced training strategies. In video-based deployments, these image classifiers are applied directly to each frame, enabling integration with existing pipelines without architectural changes.

Relying exclusively on individual frames, however, discards temporal information inherent in video data that is potentially informative for detection. [7] survey video-based fire and smoke detection approaches and highlight the benefit of modeling temporal dynamics. Representative methods include the work of [8], who combine a CNN for spatial feature extraction with a bidirectional LSTM for temporal modeling, and [9], who employ 3D CNNs with attention mechanisms to jointly capture spatio-temporal patterns. While these approaches demonstrate improved detection performance over purely image-based methods, they incur greater computational cost and require more laborious dataset construction involving temporal annotation. Hybrid methods address this partially by combining image-based classifiers with lightweight temporal post-processing — such as temporal voting [10] or motion-based false positive suppression [11] — yet still apply DL inference unconditionally to every frame, regardless of scene content.

Across both paradigms, the dominant deployment pattern applies DL inference to each frame or short clip, without considering whether inference is warranted given the frame content. In static surveillance scenarios, particularly indoors, video streams frequently consist of purely background frames with no motion, in which fire or smoke is a priori unlikely. Motivated by this observation, we propose a skip-module that filters such low-activity frames prior to DL inference, reducing computational cost while preserving detection reliability. The module prioritizes retaining positive frames (fire/smoke present) while skipping negative frames (background only), functioning as a complementary accelerator for any existing frame-wise detection pipeline.

Motion Detection and The proposed Skip Module: The skip decision in our module relies on motion estimation, which connects to the well-studied problem of background subtraction. [12] and [13] provide comprehensive reviews of background subtraction methods, ranging from simple statistical models to deep learning-based approaches. More robust methods such as MOG2 and KNN [14] model the scene background statistically and are resilient to gradual illumination changes; however, they introduce non-trivial memory overhead and initialization latency. As the skip-module is designed primarily as a fast, lightweight gate, we instead adopt frame differencing — computing the absolute per-pixel intensity change between consecutive frames — which offers minimal computational overhead and requires no background model initialization.

While classical motion detection provides an efficient means of identifying scene activity, it has not been systematically exploited to gate DL inference in fire and smoke detection pipelines. Existing efficient video inference methods, such as FrameExit [15], address per-frame redundancy but require joint training of the gating mechanism and the underlying classifier, limiting plug-and-play applicability to pre-trained models. This study bridges this gap by integrating lightweight frame-differencing-based motion estimation as a training-free gate for a high-capacity classifier, as described in Section-3.

3 The proposed method

3.1 System Overview

The proposed system is a fire and smoke detection pipeline that processes a continuous video stream and classifies each frame as either containing fire/smoke or not. The core idea is to extend the conventional pipeline with a lightweight **skip module** $\mathcal{S}$, which acts as a gating mechanism to suppress unnecessary inferences on non-informative frames, thereby improving computational efficiency. Formally, let f_t denote the video frame at time step t , $\mathcal{M}$ the DL classifier, and $\hat{y}_t \in \{0, 1\}$ the predicted label for f_t .

Baseline system. Each frame is directly passed to the classifier:

$$\hat{y}_t = \mathcal{M}(f_t)$$

Proposed system. The skip module $\mathcal{S}$ first evaluates f_t using inter-frame motion cues or other information and outputs a binary gate decision s_t . The full system output becomes:

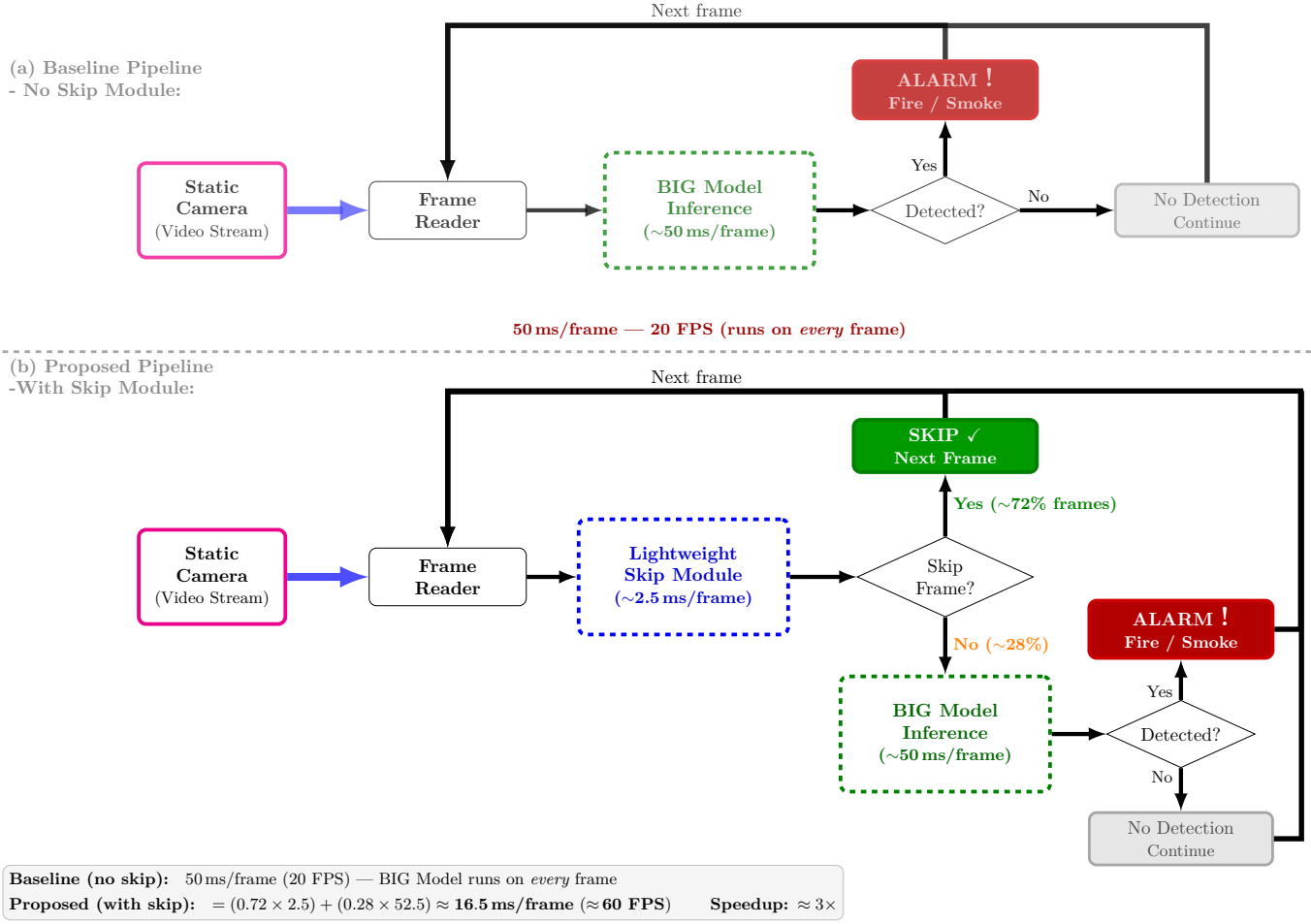


Figure 1: Proposed pipeline with Skip Frame Mechanism for Indoor Fire and Smoke Detection

$$\hat{y}_t = \begin{cases} m(f_t) & \text{if } s_t = 1 \quad (\text{run inference}) \\ 0 & \text{if } s_t = 0 \quad (\text{skip, label as negative}) \end{cases}$$

In this work, $\mathcal{S}$ derives s_t from the motion estimated between f_t and the previous frame f_{t-1} . Frames with little or no motion are unlikely to contain fire or smoke, and are therefore skipped without invoking m . The model m is typically a high-capacity, accurate classifier but is computationally expensive. The skip module $\mathcal{S}$ is intentionally lightweight, adding negligible overhead. The goal of $\mathcal{S}$ is to skip as many true-negative frames as possible while minimizing the risk of skipping true-positive frames, thus improving overall system throughput (FPS) while maintaining high accuracy for fire/smoke detection.

3.2 Skip Module Design

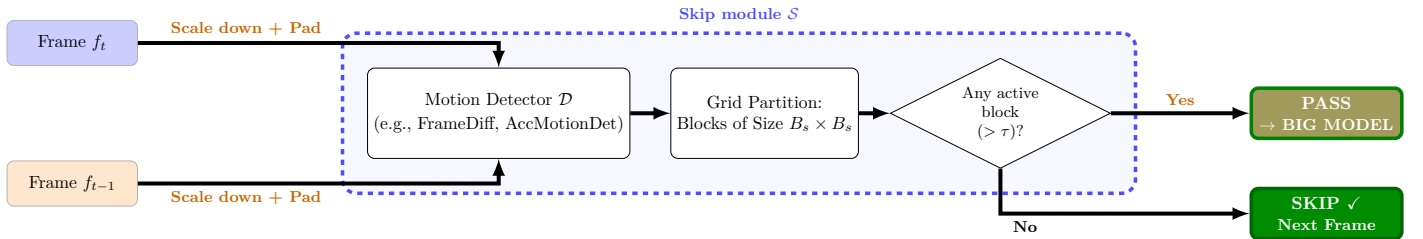


Figure 2: Skip Module for Fire and Smoke Detection

As noted above, $\mathcal{S}$ can leverage any available information — such as motion, color, or texture — to compute the skip decision s_t . In this work, we focus on motion information derived from consecutive frames as the primary cue. Specifically, we design and evaluate two motion-based instantiations of $\mathcal{S}$: (1) a frame differencing method, and (2) a motion accumulation method. Both approaches are selected for their simplicity and low computational cost, making them well-suited for real-time deployment. The overall workflow of $\mathcal{S}$ is illustrated in Figure~2 and the detailed algorithms are described in the Algorithm~1.

Algorithm 1 Skip Module $\mathcal{S}$: Motion-Based Frame Gating

Require: Video stream $\{f_1, f_2, \dots\}$, motion detector $\mathcal{D}$, scale factor α , block size B , block active threshold τ

Ensure: Skip decisions $\{s_1, s_2, \dots\}$, where $s_t \in \{0, 1\}$

```
1:  $f_{\text{prev}} \leftarrow \text{null}$  ▷ Initialize previous frame
2: for each incoming frame  $f_t$  do
    Step 1: Pre-process
3:   Downsample  $f_t$  by  $\alpha$  to obtain  $\tilde{f}_t$ 
4:   Let  $B_s \leftarrow B \cdot \alpha$  ▷ Effective block size on downsampled frame
5:   Pad  $\tilde{f}_t$  to be divisible by  $B_s$ 
    Step 2: Compute Foreground Mask
6:   if  $f_{\text{prev}} = \text{null}$  then ▷ No previous frame on first iteration
7:      $s_t \leftarrow 1$  ▷ Run inference on first frame
8:      $f_{\text{prev}} \leftarrow \tilde{f}_t$ 
9:     continue
10:  end if
11:   $\mathbf{M}_t \leftarrow \mathcal{D}(\tilde{f}_t, f_{\text{prev}})$  ▷  $\mathcal{D}$ : e.g., FrameDiff or AccMotionDet
12:  Partition  $\mathbf{M}_t$  into a grid of non-overlapping blocks of size  $B_s$ 
13:  Mark a block as active if its foreground pixel ratio  $> \tau$ 
    Step 3: Gating Decision
14:  if any active block exists then
15:     $s_t \leftarrow 1$  ▷ Motion detected, run DL inference
16:  else
17:     $s_t \leftarrow 0$  ▷ No motion, skip inference
18:  end if
19:   $f_{\text{prev}} \leftarrow \tilde{f}_t$  ▷ Update previous frame for next iteration
20:  yield  $s_t$ 
21: end for
```

3.2.1 FrameDiffDet — Naive Motion Detection

Let F_t denote the grayscale frame at time t , converted from the downsampled input $\tilde{f}_t$. $\mathbf{M}_t \in \{0, 255\}$ is the binary foreground mask output, where a pixel is declared active if the absolute inter-frame intensity change exceeds threshold τ_d . The algorithm is formalized in Algorithm 2.

Algorithm 2 Frame Difference Detector (FrameDiffDet)

Require: Downsampled frames $\tilde{f}_t, f_{\text{prev}}$

Require: τ_d : pixel difference sensitivity threshold

Ensure: $\mathbf{M}_t \in \{0, 255\}$: binary foreground mask

```
1: Convert  $\tilde{f}_t$  and  $f_{\text{prev}}$  to grayscale:  $F_t, F_{\text{prev}}$ 
2:  $\mathbf{M}_t(i, j) \leftarrow \begin{cases} 255 & |F_t(i, j) - F_{\text{prev}}(i, j)| > \tau_d \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$ 
3: return  $\mathbf{M}_t$ 
```

3.2.2 AccMotionDet — Motion Detection with Accumulation

The details of the AccMotionDet algorithm are outlined in Algorithm 3. Let F_t denote the grayscale frame at time t , converted from the downsampled input $\tilde{f}_t$, and $\mathbf{K}_t \in [0, K_{\text{max}}]$ the per-pixel *accumulated motion mask*. Upon detection, $\mathbf{K}_t$ is incremented by ω and decays by δ each frame, bounded at K_{max} to prevent indefinite accumulation of stale evidence. A pixel is declared active only when $\mathbf{K}_t \geq \tau_m$, suppressing transient noise and single-frame flicker. The binary output $\mathbf{M}_t \in \{0, 255\}$ is consistent with the interface expected by the skip module $\mathcal{S}$.

3.3 Skip Module Hyperparameter Optimization

The skip module $\mathcal{S}$ contains several hyperparameters (e.g., motion threshold, accumulation window size) that can significantly impact the performance of the overall system. To identify the optimal configuration, we employ a grid search based hyperparameter optimization procedure on a validation set D_{val} derived from our video dataset with respect to several system-wide metrics defined in Section~4.2. More specifically, to select the optimal hyperparameters for the proposed skip module, we employ a constrained optimization procedure on the validation set D_{val} . Let R_{base} , FAR_{base} , and T_{DL} denote the recall, false alarm rate, and mean per-frame inference time of the baseline pipeline (without skipping), respectively. For each candidate parameter set $\theta \in \Theta$ obtained by grid search, we evaluate the full pipeline $\text{Read} \rightarrow \mathcal{S}(\theta) \rightarrow [M]$ and compute four metrics: recall $R(\theta)$, false alarm rate $\text{FAR}(\theta)$, skip rate $S_r(\theta)$, and mean per-frame skip module time $T_{\text{skip}}(\theta)$.

Algorithm 3 Accumulation Motion Detector (AccMotionDet)

Require: Downsampled frames $\tilde{f}_t, f_{\text{prev}}$; accumulated mask $\mathbf{K}_{t-1}$ (initialized to $\mathbf{0}$)

Require: τ_d : pixel difference sensitivity, ω : motion increment, τ_m : activation threshold, $K_{\max}$: accumulation cap, δ : decay rate

Ensure: $\mathbf{M}_t \in \{0, 255\}$: binary foreground mask; $\mathbf{K}_t$: updated accumulated mask

- 1: Convert $\tilde{f}_t$ and f_{prev} to grayscale: F_t, F_{prev}
 - 2: $\mathbf{D}_t \leftarrow |F_t - F_{\text{prev}}|$ ▷ Absolute inter-frame difference
 - 3: $\Delta_t(i, j) \leftarrow \begin{cases} \omega & \mathbf{D}_t(i, j) > \tau_d \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$ ▷ Instantaneous increment map
 - 4: $\mathbf{K}_t \leftarrow \min(\mathbf{K}_{t-1} + \Delta_t, K_{\max})$ ▷ Accumulate and cap
 - 5: $\mathbf{K}_t \leftarrow \max(\mathbf{K}_t - \delta, 0)$ ▷ Temporal decay
 - 6: $\mathbf{M}_t(i, j) \leftarrow \begin{cases} 255 & \mathbf{K}_t(i, j) \geq \tau_m \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$ ▷ Threshold to binary mask
 - 7: **return** $\mathbf{M}_t, \mathbf{K}_t$
-

Algorithm 4 Skip Module Hyperparameter Selection

Require: Parameter space Θ , validation set D_{val} , DL model $\mathcal{M}$, recall tolerance δ_R , time budget β , weights w_S, w_F, w_R

Ensure: Optimal parameters θ^*

- 1: baseline $\leftarrow \text{EVALUATEPIPELINE}(D_{\text{val}}, \text{skip}=\text{None}, \mathcal{M})$
 - 2: Extract $R_{\text{base}}, \text{FAR}_{\text{base}}, T_{\text{DL}}$ from baseline
 - 3: best_score $\leftarrow -\infty$; $\theta^* \leftarrow \text{None}$
 - 4: **for** each $\theta \in \Theta$ **do**
 - 5: results $\leftarrow \text{EVALUATEPIPELINE}(D_{\text{val}}, \mathcal{S}(\theta), \mathcal{M})$
 - 6: Extract $R(\theta), \text{FAR}(\theta), S(\theta), T_{\text{skip}}(\theta)$ from results
 - 7: **if** $R(\theta) \geq R_{\text{base}} - \delta_R$ **and** $T_{\text{skip}}(\theta) \leq \beta \cdot T_{\text{DL}}$ **then**
 - 8: $F(\theta) \leftarrow \max\left(0, \frac{\text{FAR}_{\text{base}} - \text{FAR}(\theta)}{\text{FAR}_{\text{base}}}\right)$
 - 9: $\rho(\theta) \leftarrow 1 - \frac{R_{\text{base}} - R(\theta)}{\delta_R}$
 - 10: score $\leftarrow w_S S(\theta) + w_F F(\theta) + w_R \rho(\theta)$
 - 11: **if** score $>$ best_score **then**
 - 12: best_score $\leftarrow$ score
 - 13: $\theta^* \leftarrow \theta$
 - 14: **end if**
 - 15: **end if**
 - 16: **end for**
 - 17: **return** θ^*
-

The skip rate $S_r(\theta)$ is computed on D_{val} following the definition in Section~4.2, with N_{neg} instantiated as $N_{\text{neg}}^{\text{val}} = |\{f_i \in D_{\text{val}} : y_i = 0\}|$, which is fixed by the validation set and independent of θ .

The mean per-frame inference times are defined as

$$T_{\text{DL}} = \frac{1}{|D_{\text{val}}|} \sum_{i=1}^{|D_{\text{val}}|} t_{\text{DL}}(f_i), \quad T_{\text{skip}}(\theta) = \frac{1}{|D_{\text{val}}|} \sum_{i=1}^{|D_{\text{val}}|} t_{\text{skip}}(f_i, \theta),$$

where f_i denotes the i -th frame in D_{val} , and both averages are taken over all frames to reflect the runtime cost on a typical video stream.

Feasibility constraints. A candidate θ is considered feasible only if it satisfies two hard constraints:

$$R(\theta) \geq R_{\text{base}} - \delta_R, \quad T_{\text{skip}}(\theta) \leq \beta \cdot T_{\text{DL}},$$

where $\delta_R > 0$ is the maximum allowable absolute recall drop, and $\beta \in (0, 1)$ bounds the skip module overhead as a fraction of one full DL inference. For example, setting $\delta_R = 0.01$ and $\beta = 0.10$ means the system tolerates at most a 1% recall drop and requires the skip module to run within 10% of the cost of a single DL inference.

Scoring feasible candidates. To rank feasible candidates, we define two normalized scoring terms. The false alarm reduction term is

$$F(\theta) = \max\left(0, \frac{\text{FAR}_{\text{base}} - \text{FAR}(\theta)}{\text{FAR}_{\text{base}}}\right),$$

which measures the relative FAR improvement with respect to the baseline. The recall retention term is

$$\rho(\theta) = 1 - \frac{R_{\text{base}} - R(\theta)}{\delta_R},$$

which equals 1 when recall matches the baseline and 0 when recall reaches the lowest acceptable level $R_{\text{base}} - \delta_R$. Both terms are bounded in $[0, 1]$ over the feasible region, making them directly comparable to $S(\theta)$ in the weighted score.

Optimal selection. The optimal parameter set θ^* is selected as

$$\theta^* = \arg \max_{\theta \in \Theta_{\text{feasible}}} [w_S S(\theta) + w_F F(\theta) + w_R \rho(\theta)],$$

where $\Theta_{\text{feasible}} = \{\theta \in \Theta : R(\theta) \geq R_{\text{base}} - \delta_R \text{ and } T_{\text{skip}}(\theta) \leq \beta \cdot T_{\text{DL}}\}$, and the nonnegative weights satisfy $w_S + w_F + w_R = 1$.

Theoretical justification. The skip module $\mathcal{S}$ acts as a conservative gate: skipped frames are labeled negative directly, while passed frames are processed by the same downstream detector $\mathcal{M}$ as in the baseline. Therefore, every false alarm produced by the skip-enabled system is also present in the baseline, implying $\text{FAR}(\theta) \leq \text{FAR}_{\text{base}}$. The primary safety risk is recall degradation caused by incorrectly skipped fire/smoke frames, which motivates enforcing the recall constraint as a hard gate prior to any candidate ranking.

4 Experiments and Results

4.1 Fire and Smoke Indoor Video Dataset

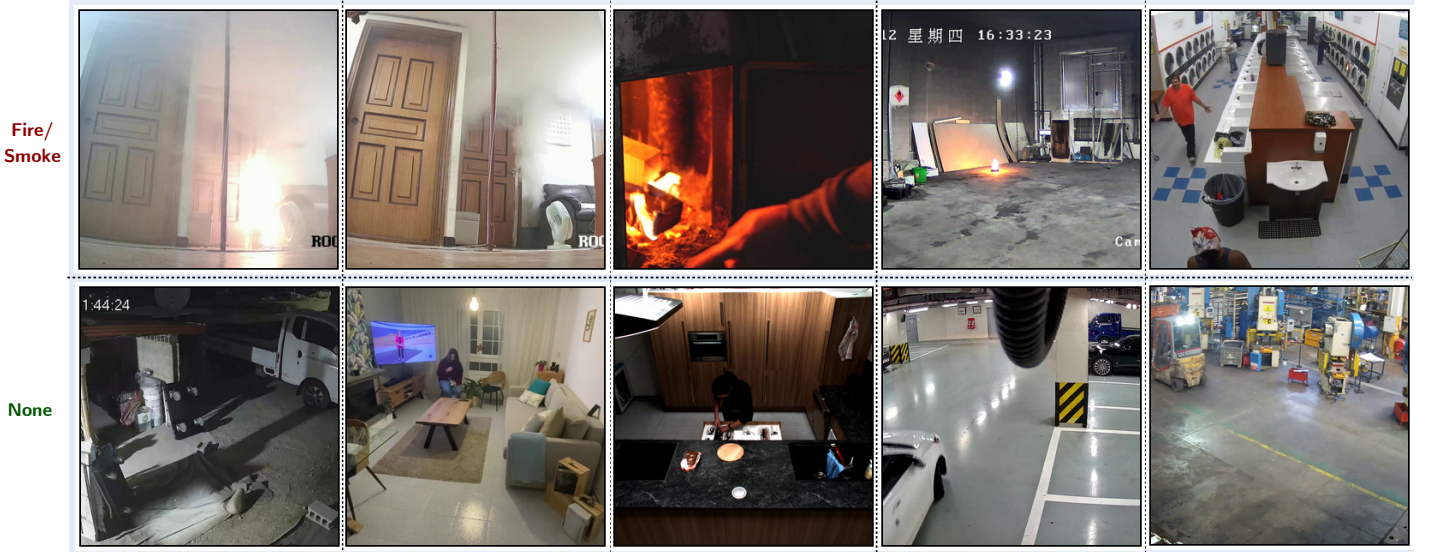


Figure 3: Representative frames extracted from videos in the indoor fire and smoke detection dataset used in this study.

Publicly available video datasets for fire and smoke detection using static cameras remain scarce. While several existing benchmarks address this detection task — including FireNet [16], Firesense [17], FiSmo [18], and FURG [19] — these were recorded with moving cameras and are therefore unsuitable for static surveillance scenarios. Static-camera datasets such as DFire [20], VisiFire Bilkent [21], KMU Fire and Smoke [22], Mivia Fire and Smoke [23], and USTC Smoke [24] do exist; however, they collectively suffer from several limitations: a predominance of outdoor scenes, a small number of video samples, low spatial resolution, and insufficient diversity in fire/smoke appearances and environmental conditions.

To address these deficiencies, we constructed a dedicated static indoor video dataset by aggregating clips from multiple heterogeneous sources. Fire and smoke samples were sourced from the Korea AI Fire Dataset [25], the USTC Smoke Dataset [24], and the VSD3K Dataset [26], supplemented by videos collected from open online platforms (Pexels, Pixabay, and YouTube). Non-fire/smoke (negative) samples were compiled from self-recorded footage captured by real CCTV cameras in various indoor environments (e.g., parking areas), along with the Safe & Unsafe Behavior in Workplaces dataset [27], the Indoor Action dataset [28], the MPII Cooking 2 Dataset [29], and the WiseNet dataset [30]. Table~?? summarizes the properties of the self-collected video dataset alongside a comparison with existing benchmark datasets, and Figure~3 presents representative sample frames.

For the hyperparameter optimization described in Section~3.3, the video dataset was further partitioned into a validation set, D_{val} (46 videos), used to select the optimal skip-module hyperparameters, and a test set, D_{test} (104 videos), used for

Table 1: Comparison of existing fire and smoke video datasets with the proposed dataset (150 videos; static CCTV cameras; diverse indoor environments). Unlike most existing benchmarks, 143 out of 150 videos are recorded at HD resolution (1280×720) or above, matching commercial surveillance camera quality.

Model	Category	Videos	Resolution Min	Resolution Max	FireSmoke	Normal	Indoor	Outdoor
FireSense (2010) [xx]	Moving camera	49	300 × 240	1600 × 1200	24	25	10	39
KMU (2011) [xx]	Static camera	38	320 × 240	320 × 240	28	10	10	28
VisiFireBilkent (2015) [xx]	Static camera	39	320 × 240	720 × 576	38	1	6	32
Mivia FIRE (2015) [xx]	Static camera	31	320 × 240	800 × 600	28	3	4	27
Mivia SMOKE (2015) [xx]	Static camera	149	292 × 240	292 × 240	76	73	0	149
FURG (2015) [xx]	Moving camera	22	240 × 344	1920 × 1080	17	5	3	19
USTC Smoke (2017) [xx]	Static camera	30	1920 × 1080	1920 × 1080	22	8	30	0
FireNet (2019) [xx]	Moving camera	62	352 × 222	1920 × 1080	46	16	30	32
FiSmo (2020) [xx]	Moving camera	88	320 × 240	1920 × 1080	80	8	0	88
D-Fire (2021) [xx]	Static camera	100	1280 × 720	1280 × 720	50	50	0	100
VSD3 (2022) [xx]	Mix camera	20	352 × 288	2048 × 1536	8	12	6	14
Ours (2026) - This work	Static camera	150	814 × 720	3840 × 2160	75	75	150	0

the final evaluation of the skip-enabled system against the baseline and existing methods. The split followed a 30:70 ratio (validation:test), following the protocol of [10], and was performed using stratified sampling to preserve balanced class distributions in both subsets.

4.2 Evaluation Metrics

Performance is evaluated under both **frame-level** and **video-level** protocols, which are commonly used in fire and smoke video analysis [20], [31]. Frame-level evaluation measures detection performance for each individual frame, providing a strict assessment of classification accuracy. Video-level evaluation aggregates predictions over entire video sequences, offering a coarser but practically relevant measure for continuous surveillance scenarios.

The following label definitions apply to both evaluation protocols:

- True Positive (TP): Correct detection of fire or smoke.
- True Negative (TN): Correct identification of the absence of fire or smoke.
- False Positive (FP): Incorrect detection of fire or smoke when none is present.
- False Negative (FN): Failure to detect fire or smoke when it is present.

Quantitative results are reported using standard classification metrics — accuracy, recall, false alarm rate (FAR), precision, F1-score, and frames per second (FPS) — as defined below.

$$\text{Accuracy} = \frac{TP + TN}{TP + TN + FP + FN}, \quad (1)$$

$$\text{True Positive Rate (TPR) = Recall (R)} = \frac{TP}{TP + FN}, \quad (2)$$

$$\text{False Positive Rate (FPR)} = \frac{FP}{FP + TN}, \quad (3)$$

$$\text{Precision (P)} = \frac{TP}{TP + FP}, \quad (4)$$

$$\text{F1-score} = 2 \times \frac{P \times R}{P + R}, \quad (5)$$

$$\text{FPS} = \frac{\text{Total processing Time (seconds)}}{\text{Total Frames}}, \quad (6)$$

$$S = \frac{N_{\text{skip}}^-}{TN + FP} \quad (7)$$

where TP , TN , FP , and FN represent True Positive, True Negative, False Positive, and False Negative, respectively.

In addition to standard metrics, we report the skip rate S_r , a system-level efficiency criterion specific to the proposed skip-based framework. Skip rate measures the proportion of ground-truth negative frames correctly bypassed by S , defined as

$$S_r = \frac{N_{\text{skip}}^-}{N_{\text{neg}}},$$

where N_{skip}^- is the number of true-negative frames for which $\mathcal{S}$ correctly outputs $s_t = 0$, and $N_{\text{neg}} = TN + FP$ is the total number of ground-truth negative frames in the evaluated set. A higher S_r indicates greater computational savings, while a drop in recall signals unsafe skipping of fire/smoke frames.

4.3 Implementation Details

Due to their distinct computational requirements, the BIG and SMALL models were trained on separate hardware configurations. The BIG model was trained on a system equipped with an Intel i9-13900K CPU and two NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4090 GPUs. Training was conducted over 100 epochs using the Stochastic Gradient Descent (SGD) optimizer with the following hyperparameters: a batch size of 128, a learning rate of 0.01, momentum of 0.9, and weight decay of 0.0001. In contrast, the SMALL model was trained on a system with an Intel i9-9900K CPU and a single NVIDIA GeForce RTX 3090 GPU. This model employed the Adam optimizer for 50 epochs with a batch size of 256, a learning rate of 0.001, ($\alpha_1 = 0.9$), ($\alpha_2 = 0.999$), and a weight decay of 0.0001.

TODO: add hardware and software context here The experiments were conducted on a workstation running Windows 10 Pro 21H2 (build 19044) equipped with a Intel Core i9-12900K processor, 64 GB of DDR5 system memory, and an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 3090 GPU (24 GB VRAM). All deep learning inference was performed under CUDA 12.9 with PyTorch 2.7.1.

4.4 Baseline Models and Context

To validate the effectiveness of the proposed skip module, we compare it against a spectrum of existing solutions ranging from heavy, high-accuracy models to lightweight, real-time approximations:

- **The “Expert” Baseline (BIG MODEL):** A state-of-the-art Deep Learning model (ResNet-50 backbone) trained on a massive proprietary dataset ($> 1M$ images). It achieves the highest accuracy but suffers from high latency ($\sim \$50\text{ms}/\text{frame}$), making it computationally prohibitive for 24/7 processing on edge devices. In this study, we trained two classification models: a high-accuracy, complex model (referred to as the BIG model) for fire and smoke detection, and a lightweight model (referred to as the SMALL model) for the skip-module.

For the BIG model, we combined images from the D-Fire dataset [20] with additional fire and smoke images collected from the internet, resulting in a total of 18,000 images (#REVISE_NEEDED). These were divided into training (80%, 14,400 images) and testing (20%, 3,600 images) sets.

For the SMALL model, we randomly extracted 80,000 64×64 patches from datasets A and B (#REVISE_NEEDED). Of these, 80% were used for training, while the remaining 20% were reserved for testing to evaluate model performance.

We construct a binary image classification dataset for fire and smoke detection, consisting of two classes: *fire/smoke* and *none*. The dataset contains 18,500 RGB images collected from publicly available sources, including FIRE Dataset and FIRESENSE Dataset, along with additional web-scraped images. The *fire/smoke* class includes images with visible flames or smoke under diverse conditions such as indoor fires, wildfires, and low-visibility environments, while the *none* class contains visually similar non-fire scenes (e.g., fog, clouds, and sunlight glare) to reduce false positives. The images vary in resolution from (480×1) to (1920×1080) , and the dataset is split into 70% training, 10% validation, and 20% testing subsets with balanced class distribution. Prior to training, all images are resized to (224×224) and normalized using ImageNet statistics, and data augmentation techniques including random horizontal flipping, rotation ($\pm 15^\circ$), color jittering, and random cropping are applied to improve robustness to variations in illumination, scale, and viewpoint. The model is implemented using PyTorch and trained on a single NVIDIA RTX 3090 GPU. Optimization is performed using the Adam optimizer with an initial learning rate of (1×10^{-4}) and weight decay of (1×10^{-5}) , and the model is trained for 100 epochs with a batch size of 32. A cosine annealing learning rate schedule with a 5-epoch warm-up is employed to stabilize training, and gradient clipping with a maximum norm of 5.0 is applied to prevent instability. The training objective is binary cross-entropy loss, and model selection is based on validation F1-score, with early stopping applied if performance does not improve for 10 consecutive epochs. Final performance is reported on the held-out test set using accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score.

- **M1 (Lightweight Classifier) [16]:** A MobileNetV2-based classifier trained on a smaller subset ($< 5k$ images). It represents the standard “efficiency” compromise: low latency ($\sim \$15\text{ms}$) but reduced generalization capability.
- **M2 (Lightweight Detector) [10]:** A YOLOv8-Nano object detector trained on a small dataset ($\sim \$2k$ images). It offers localization but struggles with small or semi-transparent smoke features due to limited training data.
- **M3 (Temporal Voting Method) [10]:** A video-level approach that aggregates inference results over a sliding window of 30 frames to reduce false alarms. While effective for reducing noise, it introduces inherent algorithmic latency.

4.5 Results

4.5.1 Hyperparameter Optimization Results

In this work, we set

$$w_S = 0.60, \quad w_F = 0.20, \quad w_R = 0.20,$$

so that skip rate remains the primary efficiency objective, while false alarm reduction and recall retention are treated as secondary but explicitly rewarded preferences.

Frame Diff Parameter Grid Search:

4.5.1.1 Hyperparameter Search Space for the FrameDiffDet Skip Module To identify an optimal configuration for the `motion_only_block_skip_proc` module using `FrameDiffDet` as its motion estimator, we conducted a systematic grid search over four parameters: `scale_factor`, `block_size_orig`, `block_ratio_th`, and `diff_thresh`. The search space was defined as follows:

Table 2: Grid search space for the `FrameDiffDet` skip module hyperparameters.

Parameter	Search Values
<code>scale_factor</code>	{0.5, 1.0}
<code>block_size_orig</code>	{16, 32}
<code>block_ratio_th</code>	{0.05, 0.10, 0.15}
<code>diff_thresh</code>	{3, 5, 7, 10}
<i>Total configurations: $2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 4 = 48$</i>	

To identify an optimal configuration for the `motion_only_block_skip_proc` module using `FrameDiffDet` as its motion estimator, we conducted a systematic grid search over four hyperparameters: `scale_factor`, `block_size_orig`, `block_ratio_th`, and `diff_thresh`. The search space is summarized in Table~2, yielding a total of $2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 4 = 48$ configurations.

`scale_factor` {0.5, 1.0}. The scale factor controls the spatial resolution at which per-block frame differences are computed. Full resolution (1.0) preserves fine-grained pixel detail, while half resolution (0.5) reduces sensitivity to high-frequency pixel noise that may generate spurious motion signals unrelated to actual scene changes. Two levels are evaluated to quantify the effect of pre-computation downscaling on both detection reliability and computational cost.

`block_size_orig` {16, 32}. Block size determines the spatial granularity of the motion map, expressed in pixels of the original unscaled frame. Fine blocks (16 px) enable detection of localized motion from small or nascent fire regions, whereas coarser blocks (32 px) aggregate motion evidence over a broader spatial context, offering greater robustness against isolated pixel-level disturbances. This range is chosen to span a practically meaningful fine-to-coarse spectrum without becoming so coarse that spatially small fire events are missed entirely.

`block_ratio_th` {0.05, 0.10, 0.15}. This threshold defines the minimum fraction of motion-active blocks required to trigger a full inference pass; frames below this threshold are skipped. A low value (0.05) corresponds to a conservative policy where even sparse motion activity triggers inference, minimizing the risk of missed detections. A higher value (0.15) reflects a more aggressive skip policy that demands broader scene-level motion before committing to inference. The three values are spaced at a uniform interval of 0.05 to enable a systematic and interpretable sweep across this conservative-to-aggressive spectrum.

`diff_thresh` {3, 5, 7, 10}. The per-pixel difference threshold determines the minimum absolute intensity change required for a pixel to be counted as a motion event within a block. A low threshold (3) is highly sensitive and responds to subtle illumination changes, while a high threshold (10) responds only to strong, unambiguous motion. The four values are selected to span the full sensitivity spectrum — from near-noise-level detection to robust large-motion detection — with closer spacing at the lower end (3, 5, 7) to provide finer resolution in the sensitivity range most relevant to fire detection, where motion tends to be subtle and spatially confined.

Table~3 specifies the search space for the rule-based skip-module parameters. The ranking and selection of the optimal configuration (θ^*) based on the validation set results are detailed in Table~4. Table~?? shows an example of the validation-time ranking. The selected configuration θ_1^* satisfies the recall constraint and achieves the highest composite score by jointly balancing skip ratio, false alarm reduction, and recall retention.

Table 3: Hyperparameter search space and selected settings for both skip-module variants.

Group	Parameter	A1 (Baseline)	A2 (Proposed)	Note
Shared	Grid size ($N \times N$)	16×16	16×16	Balances spatial sensitivity and runtime cost.
Shared	Motion threshold	2.0	1.5	Lower threshold helps capture subtle smoke motion.
Fire color rule	Red threshold	N/A	selected	Detects bright flame-like red regions.
	Saturation threshold	N/A	selected	Helps reject non-fire bright objects.
	Intensity threshold	N/A	selected	Focuses on strong flame responses.
Smoke grayness rule	Grayness range	N/A	[0.7, 0.95]	Captures low-saturation semi-transparent smoke.
	Texture consistency	N/A	selected	Helps distinguish smoke from random motion.
Temporal rule	Window size (frames)	minimal	5	Suppresses transient noise and improves stability.

This formulation is systematic, interpretable, and aligned with the intended role of the skip module in real-time fire/smoke detection: preserve recall first, then prefer candidates that skip more negative frames while still improving operational false alarm behavior.

Table 4: Validation-set performance under the hard safety constraint Recall(Anomaly). Final model selected by maximizing SkipScore among feasible configurations.

Method	Configuration	Recall (Val)	Filter Rate (Val)	SkipScore	Role
A1 (Baseline)	16×16 2.0 motion only	97.2	65.0	N/A	Motion-only baseline – fails safety target (<99).
A2 (Proposed)	16×16 1.5 smoke rules	99.1	72.1	0.714	Selected final configuration.
A2 (Proposed)	16×16 2.0 smoke rules	99.0	68.3	0.676	Safe but less efficient.
A2 (Proposed)	32×32 1.0 smoke rules	99.2	65.7	0.652	Slightly higher recall lower efficiency.

4.5.2 System-Level Performance: Frame-Based Efficiency

We subsequently integrated the skip modules into the full inference pipeline to measure end-to-end efficiency. System latency for our method is calculated as the inherent skip module overhead plus the conditional latency of the BIG MODEL applied only to unskipped frames.

The overall impact of integrating the skip modules into the full detection pipeline is quantified in Table 5 (frame-level accuracy/latency), also comparing against the baseline system without skipping.

Table 5: End-to-End System Performance Comparison on Test Set.

Config	Recall	False Alarm Rate	Accuracy	Skip Rate	FPS
BIG MODEL only	98.5%	50.0ms	312	0%	20
M1	76.0%	15.0ms	123123	70%	66
M2	81.5%	22.0ms	123123	56%	45
Ours (Appr. 1 + BIG)	98.3%	18.3ms	123	63%	54
Ours (Appr. 2 + BIG)	98.5%	16.5ms	3123123	67%	60

Analysis: Simply replacing the BIG MODEL with lightweight alternatives (M1, M2) results in an unacceptable 17-22% degradation in F1-Score. Our proposed pipeline (Approach 2 + BIG MODEL) successfully bridges this gap. By filtering 72.1% of frames at a cost of only 2.5ms per frame, the average system latency drops to 16.5ms. This achieves a 67% reduction in computational cost, tripling the effective frame rate from 20 FPS to 60 FPS while perfectly matching the Baseline’s 98.5% F1-Score.

4.5.3 Comparison with Temporal Methods (M3)

A critical distinction in anomaly detection is between frame-level and video-level processing. The M3 baseline reduces false alarms by executing majority voting across a 30-frame window. While highly accurate, this architectural choice introduces significant latency.

Table 6 compares our method against other temporal processing techniques, evaluating both detection performance and computational efficiency.

Table 6: Comparison of Video-level performance metrics, measuring the delay and initial detection speed.

Method	Scope	Delay/Frame	Min Latency	First Alarm	Compute/Sec	Video Recall	False Alarm
M3 Temporal Voting	Video(30f)	25ms/f	30 Frames	>750ms	750ms	97.5%	1.2%
Ours (Appr.2+BIG)	Frame-level	16.5ms/f	1 Frame	52.5ms	495ms	98.4%	1.5%

Analysis: Because M3 requires a full temporal buffer before confirming an event, the system inherently delays the alarm trigger by over 750ms. In contrast, our frame-level approach triggers the BIG MODEL immediately upon detecting heuristic indicators. This results in a time-to-first-alarm of approximately 52.5ms, making our method over 14 times faster to react than temporal aggregation methods. Even when evaluated strictly on video-level metrics, our skip-module approach achieves higher recall and requires significantly less aggregate computational time per second of video, proving highly competitive in false alarm suppression.

4.5.4 Ablation and Qualitative Analysis

4.5.4.1 Component Analysis: Efficacy of the Skip Module First, we evaluate the skip modules in isolation to ensure they function as safe gatekeepers. The primary objective is to maximize the Filter Rate without compromising Recall. Because the ultimate goal of the system is simply to detect whether *any* hazard exists (regardless of whether it is fire or smoke), we measure safety using a unified anomaly recall metric. We also compare this against the recall capabilities of the lightweight standalone models (M1 and M2).

Table 7 assesses the intrinsic recall and filtering capability of each method as a standalone component.

Table 7: Compare our BIG MODEL (no skip module) performance against other lightweight DL classifier or Object Detectors.

Method	Recall	False Alarm Rate	FPS
M1 (MobileNetV2 Classifier)	80.0%	10.0%	30
M2 (YOLOv8-Nano Detector)	85.0%	8.0%	45
BIG model	90.0%	5.0%	60

Analysis: As demonstrated in Table 7, lightweight standalone models (M1 and M2) offer fast processing but miss between 11% and 15% of critical anomaly events. Approach 1 (Naive Motion) operates extremely fast (1.2ms) but struggles with the slow, diffusing nature of smoke. This deficiency drags its overall combined Recall down to 97.2%—an unacceptable safety margin for early-warning systems. Conversely, our proposed Approach 2 integrates color and texture heuristics to successfully capture both rapid flames and semi-transparent smoke. It achieves a near-perfect combined Recall of 99.1% while actually improving the Filter Rate to 72.1% by effectively distinguishing true anomaly indicators from environmental noise (e.g., swaying trees).

To isolate the impact of our specific heuristic rules, we conducted an ablation study comparing the naive motion baseline (Approach 1) against the full rule-based engine (Approach 2). While Approach 1 performed adequately for dynamic, rapidly flickering fires, its recall dropped significantly on smoke events. Because smoke diffuses slowly and lacks sharp edge transitions, naive background subtraction thresholds frequently misclassified it as static background lighting changes.

The integration of the rule-based engine in Approach 2—specifically the grayish-color tracking and temporal texture consistency rules—corrected this deficiency, bridging the gap in Recall. This quantitative improvement is supported by qualitative reviews of edge cases (see Figure 4).

(Insert Figure 4 here: 2x2 grid showing a frame with smoke missed by Appr 1 but caught by Appr 2, and a safe frame with swaying trees flagged by Appr 1 but skipped by Appr 2).

As illustrated in Figure 4, Approach 2 successfully captures slow-diffusion smoke events that lack the raw pixel displacement required to trigger Approach 1. Furthermore, in scenes featuring subtle twilight illumination shifts and swaying foliage, Approach 1 frequently generated false positives (unnecessarily passing safe frames to the BIG MODEL). Approach 2 successfully filtered these frames by applying color-channel heuristics, verifying that the moving pixels did not match the chromatic signatures of either fire or smoke.

Speed of Skip Module:

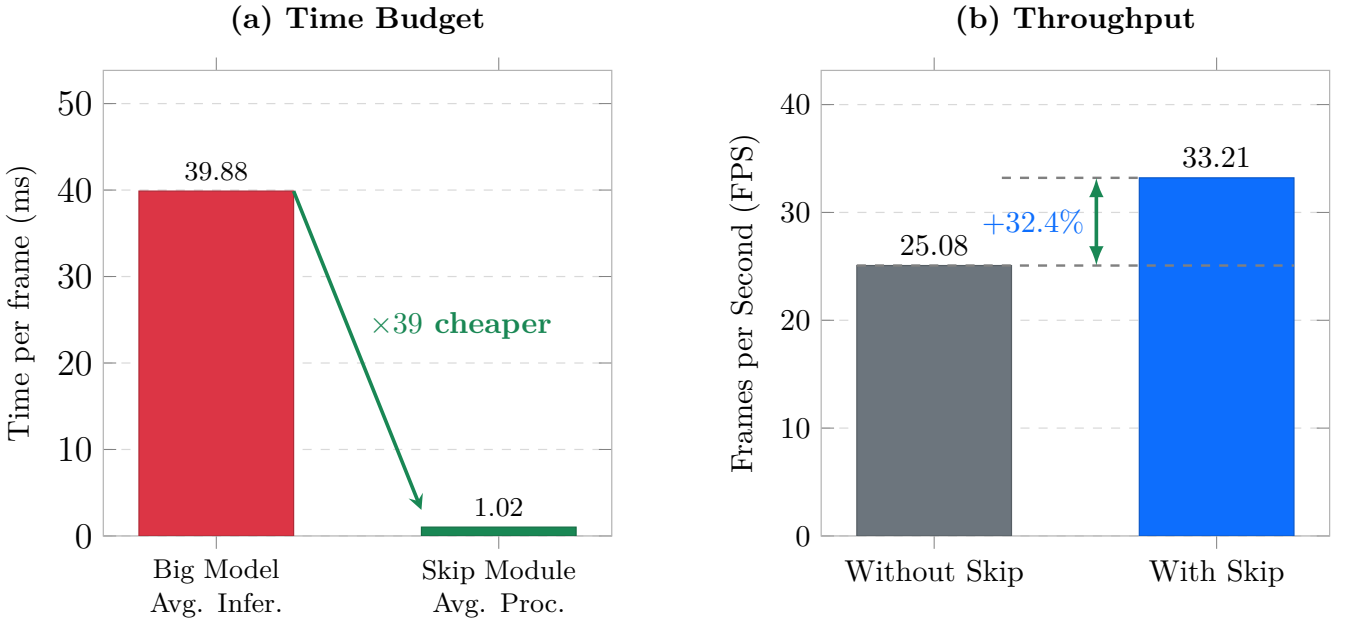


Figure 4: Proposed pipeline with Skip Frame Mechanism for Indoor Fire and Smoke Detection

5 Conclusion

We propose a lightweight, plug-and-play skip module $\mathcal{S}$ designed to accelerate real-time fire and smoke detection in indoor surveillance scenarios. Operating at a tiny fraction ($\approx 2.5\%$) of the computational cost of the DL classifier $\mathcal{M}$, $\mathcal{S}$ efficiently

filters out static background frames before they reach $\mathcal{M}$, reducing unnecessary inference overhead. Experiments on a real-world video dataset demonstrate that the proposed approach yields a throughput improvement of over 30% in frames per second while maintaining detection reliability.

Nevertheless, the proposed approach has several limitations. First, $\mathcal{S}$ relies solely on inter-frame motion cues, which may be unsuitable for outdoor surveillance scenarios where persistent motion sources — such as wind, moving vehicles, etc. — are continuously present, potentially causing $\mathcal{S}$ to pass the majority of frames to $\mathcal{M}$ and negating the efficiency gain. Second, the hyperparameters of $\mathcal{S}$ require dataset-specific tuning prior to deployment, incurring additional optimization overhead. Third, the overall detection accuracy of the system remains bounded by the capacity of $\mathcal{M}$, which is treated as a fixed component and not optimized in this work.

Future work may explore alternative skip strategies — such as leveraging color, texture, or learned features as gating cues — and extend the framework to outdoor surveillance scenarios where motion-based filtering is less effective.

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